

Agent Tesla Malware Report

Agent Tesla — Malware Analysis Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

1. Executive Summary

Agent Tesla is a long-running .NET spyware and credential-stealing Trojan that remains highly prevalent in current sandbox telemetry. ANY.RUN's tracker ranked it second by recent public task volume, while MITRE ATT&CK documents Agent Tesla as observed since at least 2014. Its impact comes from broad credential theft, keylogging, screenshots, system discovery, persistence, and exfiltration over web, SMTP, and FTP channels.

Confirmed Agent Tesla activity should be handled as credential exposure. Response should prioritize endpoint containment, mailbox and browser credential review, password resets, token/session invalidation, and inspection of outbound SMTP/FTP/web exfiltration.

2. Sample Metadata

Field	Assessment
Family	Agent Tesla
Type	Spyware Trojan / infostealer / keylogger
Runtime	Commonly .NET
Platform	Windows
First seen	MITRE lists observed since at least 2014
Current ranking	#2 on ANY.RUN current tracker; 287 tasks in last seven days shown
Common delivery	Phishing attachments, archives, scripts, Office-themed lures
Confidence	High for capabilities; medium for rotating infrastructure

3. Source Review & Confidence

Claim	Source	Date	Confidence	Notes
Agent Tesla is spyware that records keystrokes and user interactions.	ANY.RUN Agent Tesla overview	Accessed 2026-06-01	High	Family overview and sample telemetry.
Agent Tesla is a .NET spyware Trojan observed since at least 2014.	MITRE ATT&CK S0331	Last modified 2025-04-16	High	ATT&CK software entry.
Agent Tesla can use HTTP, SMTP, and persistence via Run keys/startup folder.	MITRE ATT&CK S0331	Last modified 2025-04-16	High	Technique mapping.
Recent Agent Tesla campaigns continue to use archives/scripts and FTP exfiltration patterns.	Yazoul / ANY.RUN-linked reporting	2026-04 to 2026-05	Medium	Secondary aggregation.

3.1 Expanded Source Matrix

Source	Contribution	Confidence
ANY.RUN Malware Trends Tracker	Current rank and task volume.	High
ANY.RUN Agent Tesla overview	Family behavior, samples, infrastructure, and representative indicators.	High
MITRE ATT&CK S0331	Technique mapping and long-term behavior model.	High
Fortinet 2026 multi-stage campaign analysis	In-memory payload delivery, anti-analysis checks, and theft/exfiltration stages.	High
Fortinet Agent Tesla outbreak report	Defensive controls and broader campaign context.	Medium / High
Yazoul Agent Tesla reporting	Recent sample and detection telemetry.	Medium
ANY.RUN Malware Trends Report 2025	Commodity stealer/RAT context.	High

3.2 Evidence Ledger

Claim	Evidence	Confidence	Analyst Note
Agent Tesla is mature .NET spyware with keylogging and credential theft.	MITRE S0331 and ANY.RUN family overview.	High	Capability set is stable across years.
Agent Tesla frequently exfiltrates via mail, FTP, or web protocols.	MITRE mappings and campaign analyses.	High	Direct SMTP/FTP from workstations is a strong hunt lead.
Modern campaigns use multi-stage and memory-resident execution.	Fortinet 2026 campaign analysis.	High for that campaign	Do not assume every sample is fileless.
Anti-analysis and AV/process-kill behavior may be present.	MITRE and Fortinet.	Medium / High	Validate per sample.

4. Payload Variants and Delivery

Agent Tesla is typically distributed through phishing and commodity loader chains. Recent public reporting shows archive and script-based delivery, including RAR, TGZ, VBS, BAT, PowerShell, and executable payloads. Operators frequently use legitimate mail and hosting infrastructure in the exfiltration path, complicating block decisions.

4.1 Ecosystem and Campaign Notes

Agent Tesla persists because it is reliable, widely understood by operators, and easy to pair with phishing, archive attachments, script loaders, and commodity crypters. It is not novel, but that is part of the risk: many organizations tune for advanced intrusion while direct credential theft over SMTP or FTP remains effective.

The more recent defensive challenge is execution style. Some campaigns stage Agent Tesla in memory, perform environmental checks, and avoid dropping obvious payloads. This shifts detection from static file matching toward parent-child process lineage, script telemetry, credential-store access, and outbound exfiltration protocols.

5. Infection Chain Analysis

1. User opens a phishing attachment or archive.
2. Script or executable launches Agent Tesla or a loader.
3. Malware profiles the host and collects local account/system information.
4. Persistence may be established through registry Run keys or startup folder placement.
5. Credentials, keystrokes, screenshots, browser data, mail client data, and FTP/VPN/application credentials may be harvested.
6. Data is exfiltrated over SMTP, FTP, HTTP, or HTTPS.

6. Technical Analysis

Key behaviors:

- Keylogging and user interaction capture.
- Browser, email client, FTP client, and application credential harvesting.
- System information discovery.
- Data staging and encryption/encoding before exfiltration.
- SMTP and FTP exfiltration are especially important telemetry points.
- Persistence through autorun locations.

6.1 Static Analysis Expectations

When a binary is available, review:

- .NET metadata, assembly names, resources, and obfuscator fingerprints.
- SMTP, FTP, HTTP/S, Telegram, or panel configuration values.
- Hardcoded email accounts, recipient addresses, ports, credentials, and server names.
- Strings for browser, mail client, VPN, FTP, and application credential targets.
- Anti-analysis process names, VM checks, and AV-kill logic.
- Persistence strings and startup paths.

6.2 Dynamic Analysis Expectations

Capture:

- Parent chain from email attachment/archive/script to payload.
- Attempts to enumerate host, network, wireless, and user details.
- Access to browser stores, mail clients, FTP clients, VPN clients, and application credential locations.
- Outbound SMTP/FTP sessions, including process identity and destination.
- Registry Run key/startup writes.
- Screenshot, keylogging, clipboard, and form-grab behavior.

7. Indicators of Compromise

7.1 Indicator Summary

Indicator Class	Count	Confidence	Recommended Use
SHA256 hashes	5 representative	High	Exact-match sweep.
IP addresses	5 representative	Medium	Hunt and enrich.
Domains	8 representative	Low / Medium	Many are legitimate SMTP providers; require context.
URLs	3 representative	Medium	Hunt web/proxy logs.
Host indicators	Behavioral	High	Best detection value.

7.2 File Hashes

Type	Indicator	Confidence	Handling
SHA256	97e004f0fc5d458d290402f9e4060c04be4832a40dd05ccc34de86c1211496d4	High	Exact-match sweep.
SHA256	4c300ed5aded08c36854fa3beec5468ac6ff35670244fe1f088d3bdb19c3a46	High	Exact-match sweep.
SHA256	e8da65e395c309509563df99675f2ddaa5339b55fd944867a479ffc5d3639946	High	Exact-match sweep.
SHA256	7b4943d925f431aae56aca2d86c4ad5b0bde681057969c2d15e06b2085340e27	High	Exact-match sweep.
SHA256	e27803fb6b9145189362039382b557561cc6054fb5981e0059fd854d2342b0ad	High	Exact-match sweep.

7.3 Network Indicators

Type	Indicator	Confidence	Handling
IP	76.74.235.200	Medium	Enrich before blocking.
IP	38.68.47.62	Medium	Hunt recent connections.
IP	92.38.178.11	Medium	Hunt recent connections.
IP	198.23.221.13	Medium	Hunt recent connections.
IP	66.29.151.236	Medium	Hunt recent connections.
Domain	smtp.gmail.com	Low	Legitimate; suspicious only with unknown process and direct SMTP.
Domain	smtp.zoho.com	Low	Legitimate mail provider.
Domain	smtp.mail.ru	Low	Legitimate mail provider.
Domain	mail.privateemail.com	Low	Legitimate mail provider.
Domain	secure.emailsrvr.com	Low	Legitimate mail provider.

7.4 URL / Config Indicators

Type	Indicator	Confidence	Handling
URL	http://ffhackti-57920.portmap.io:57920/panel/getCommand.php	Medium	Hunt; portmap is dual-use.
URL	http://ffhackti-57920.portmap.io:57920/panel/receive.php	Medium	Hunt exfil activity.
URL	http://198.98.55.114/rights/inc/0b221f05c8d6c3.php	Medium	Hunt web connections.

7.5 Host Indicators

Type	Indicator	Confidence	Notes
Persistence	Registry Run key or startup folder copy	High	ATT&CK-mapped behavior.
Network	Unsigned process initiating SMTP/FTP	High	Strong when process is user-profile executable.
Behavior	Browser credential DB access followed by network exfil	High	High-fidelity EDR correlation.

7.6 IOC Usage Guidance

Do not block major SMTP providers or FTP services solely from this report. Hunt for unusual direct SMTP/FTP connections from workstations, suspicious parent processes, unknown .NET binaries, and credentials being accessed shortly before outbound mail/file-transfer sessions.

8. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	Name	Rationale
T1087.001	Local Account Discovery	Agent Tesla collects account information.
T1082	System Information Discovery	Collects host and OS details.
T1547.001	Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder	Persistence mechanism.
T1056.001	Keylogging	Core spyware capability.
T1113	Screen Capture	User surveillance.
T1555	Credentials from Password Stores	Browser/application credential theft.
T1071.001	Web Protocols	HTTP C2/exfil.
T1071.003	Mail Protocols	SMTP-based exfiltration.
T1048	Exfiltration Over Alternative Protocol	FTP/SMTP exfiltration.

9. Detection Engineering

Sigma - Suspicious SMTP or FTP From User-Writable Executable

```

title: Suspicious SMTP Or FTP From User Writable Executable
id: e546d5f0-3f45-4d75-9b2a-agenttesla-0001
status: experimental
description: Detects workstation executables in user-writable paths initiating SMTP or FTP connections consistent with Agent Tesla
references:
  - https://attack.mitre.org/software/S0331/
  - https://any.run/malware-trends/agenttesla/
author: Lost Boys Cyber
date: 2026-06-01
tags:
  - attack.exfiltration
  - attack.t1048
  - attack.command_and_control
  - attack.t1071.003
logsource:
  product: windows
  category: network_connection
detection:
  selection_path:
    Image|contains:
      - '\AppData\'
      - '\Temp\'
      - '\Users\Public\'
  selection_ports:
    DestinationPort:
      - 21
      - 25
      - 465
      - 587
  condition: selection_path and selection_ports
falsepositives:
  - Approved mail clients, backup tools, and developer workflows; tune by signer, process name, and asset role.
level: high

```

KQL Hunt

```

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where RemotePort in (21, 25, 465, 587)
| where InitiatingProcessFolderPath has_any ("\\AppData\\", "\\Temp\\", "\\Users\\Public\\")

```

| project Timestamp, DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine, RemoteUrl, RemoteIP, RemotePort,

YARA - Agent Tesla-Like .NET Credential Theft

```
rule MAL_Win_AgentTesla_Like_CredExfil {
  meta:
    author = "Lost Boys Cyber"
    date = "2026-06-01"
    description = "Hunts .NET spyware with mail/FTP and credential theft strings"
  strings:
    $dotnet = "mscorlib.dll" ascii wide
    $smtp1 = "SmtpClient" ascii wide
    $smtp2 = "smtp." ascii wide nocase
    $ftp = "FtpWebRequest" ascii wide
    $cred1 = "Login Data" ascii wide
    $cred2 = "keylogger" ascii wide nocase
  condition:
    uint16(0) == 0x5A4D and $dotnet and 3 of ($smtp*, $ftp, $cred*)
}
```

10. Threat Hunting

Hypothesis: If Agent Tesla is present, a suspicious .NET executable from a user-writable path will access credential stores and then initiate SMTP, FTP, or web exfiltration.

Hunts:

- New direct SMTP/FTP from non-mail-client processes.
- Browser credential database reads by unknown processes.
- Registry autoruns pointing to recently created .NET binaries.
- Archive/script attachments spawning executables.

10.1 Additional Hunt Queries

SPL:

```
index=endpoint (dest_port=21 OR dest_port=25 OR dest_port=465 OR dest_port=587)
(process_path="*\\AppData\\*" OR process_path="*\\Temp\\*" OR process_path="*\\Users\\Public\\*")
| stats earliest(_time) latest(_time) values(dest) values(command_line) by host user process_name process_path
```

KQL credential-store correlation:

```
DeviceFileEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FolderPath has_any ("\\Google\\Chrome\\User Data\\", "\\Microsoft\\Edge\\User Data\\", "\\Mozilla\\Firefox\\Profi")
| where InitiatingProcessFolderPath has_any ("\\AppData\\", "\\Temp\\", "\\Users\\Public\\")
```

11. Triage and Incident Response

1. Isolate host and preserve EDR timeline.
2. Collect phishing email, attachment hash, process tree, autoruns, network connections, and credential-store access events.
3. Reset user passwords and rotate credentials saved in browsers, mail clients, FTP clients, VPN clients, and developer tools.
4. Revoke sessions and OAuth tokens.
5. Review mailbox rules and outbound mail abuse.

11.1 Identity and Data Exposure Analysis

Agent Tesla incidents should produce an identity-exposure worksheet:

Data Class	Examples	Response
Browser credentials	Saved passwords, cookies, local state	Reset passwords, revoke sessions.
Email credentials	Outlook, Thunderbird, webmail artifacts	Reset, review forwarding rules and OAuth grants.
FTP/VPN/RMM credentials	FileZilla, VPN profiles, remote tools	Rotate, check remote access logs.
Screenshots/keylogs	Typed secrets and business data	Assess data exposure and notification requirements.

12. Validation and Emulation

Use controlled lab tests for direct SMTP/FTP from user-writable paths and credential-store access simulation. Validate false positives against approved mail, backup, and automation tools before production blocking.

13. Recommendations

Priority	Owner	Timeline	Action
Critical	SOC	24 hours	Alert on direct SMTP/FTP from non-standard user-profile executables.
High	IAM	24-72 hours	Rotate credentials after confirmed infection.
High	Email Security	7 days	Block or detonate archive/script attachments with executable payloads.
Medium	Endpoint Engineering	30 days	Restrict script execution and unknown .NET binaries from user-writable paths.

14. References and Refresh Notes

- ANY.RUN Malware Trends Tracker: <https://anyrun.de/malware-trends/>
- ANY.RUN Agent Tesla overview: <https://any.run/malware-trends/agenttesla/>
- MITRE ATT&CK Agent Tesla S0331: <https://attack.mitre.org/software/S0331/>
- Fortinet Agent Tesla multi-stage campaign analysis: <https://www.fortinet.com/blog/threat-research/unmasking-agent-tesla-deep-dive-into-multi-stage-campaign>
- Fortinet Agent Tesla malware attack report:
https://filestore.fortinet.com/fortiguard/outbreak_alert/agent_tesla_malware_attack/report.pdf

- Yazoul Agent Tesla April 2026 report:
<https://www.yazoul.net/malware/agent-tesla/reports/2026-04-23/>
- ANY.RUN Malware Trends Report 2025: <https://any.run/cybersecurity-blog/malware-trends-2025/>

14.1 Intelligence Gaps

- SMTP/FTP indicators are often operator-specific and short-lived.
- Fileless campaigns may leave fewer disk artifacts.
- Public samples may overrepresent noisy phishing campaigns.
- Credential exposure scope depends on local user behavior and saved secrets, not only malware capability.